Fiscal Year:	FY 2010	**Task Last Updated:**	FY 09/03/2010
PI Name:	Limoli, Charles Ph.D.		
Project Title:	Oxidative stress as a mechanism for altering acute and chronic functional changes in the CNS exposed to low dose, low dose rates, and mixed fields of protons and HZE nuclei		
Division Name:	Human Research		
Program/Discipline:	HUMAN RESEARCH		
Program/Discipline--Element/Subdiscipline:	HUMAN RESEARCH--Radiation Biology		
Joint Agency Name:		**TechPort:**	No
Human Research Program Elements:	(1) **SR**:Space Radiation		
Human Research Program Risks:	(1) **BMed**:Risk of Adverse Cognitive or Behavioral Conditions and Psychiatric Disorders		
Space Biology Element:	None		
Space Biology Cross-Element Discipline:	None		
Space Biology Special Category:	None		
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City:	Irvine	**State:**	CA
Zip Code:	92697-2695	**Congressional District:**	45
Comments:			
Project Type:	Ground	**Solicitation / Funding Source:**	2008 Space Radiobiology NNJ08ZSA001N
Start Date:	07/01/2009	**End Date:**	06/30/2012
No. of Post Docs:	1	**No. of PhD Degrees:**	1
No. of PhD Candidates:		**No. of Master' Degrees:**	
No. of Master's Candidates:		**No. of Bachelor's Degrees:**	
No. of Bachelor's Candidates:		**Monitoring Center:**	NASA ARC
Contact Monitor:	Cucinott1a, Francis	**Contact Phone:**	281-483-0968
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Flight Program:			
Flight Assignment:			
Key Personnel Changes/Previous PI:			
COI Name (Institution):	Huang, Ting-Ting (VA Palo Alto Health Care System) Elmore, Eugene (University of California Irvine)		
Grant/Contract No.:	NNX09AK25G		
Performance Goal No.:			
Performance Goal Text:			

Task Description:	The space radiation environment poses unique hazards that include solar particle events and galactic cosmic rays. These types of radiations have been shown to cause acute and long-lasting chemical changes referred to as oxidative stress that can alter the normal physiology of the central nervous system (CNS). The chemical species produced can cause a wide range of effects in cells within the CNS that largely depend on the types of pathways they activate and the types of damage they produce. Proper functioning of the CNS depends on many factors, but is known to require subpopulations of neural stem and precursor cells that participate in the repair of CNS injury resulting from irradiation. Our proposal is focused on analyzing the effects of space radiation on these critical populations of multipotent neural stem and precursor cells. We have developed the technology to isolate and grow these cells in culture and will use a variety of techniques to analyze how cells exposed to space radiation change. We will monitor the time course of oxidative stress in these cells and how that depends on the dose, the dose rate and type of radiation applied. We will determine how radiation-induced oxidative stress impacts cellular proliferation, signaling between cells, cell fate and survival. Collectively our studies using both rodent and human neural stem and precursor cells will help NASA understand the acute and longer-lasting sequelae associated with the exposure of the CNS to the space radiation environment. These studies will facilitate efforts to more appropriately establish estimates of risk for radiation exposure to the CNS in space.
Rationale for HRP Directed Research:	
Research Impact/Earth Benefits:	Results from these studies will be critical in enhancing our knowledge base of the risks associated with exposure of the brain to the radiation fields in space.
Task Progress:	We have initiated a number of the experiments proposed in our currently funded NASA grant. Our overarching goal is aimed at determining if/how low dose and low dose rate proton and HZE charged particle irradiation leads to oxidative stress in neural precursor cells, and whether oxidative stress constitutes a biochemical mechanism responsible for disrupting cellular physiology and promoting cognitive dysfunction. Our past data has demonstrated that the radiation response of multipotent neural precursor cells to x-rays, protons, and HZE nuclei involves an acute and persistent oxidative stress that can last for months. The importance of neural precursor cells to the repair and remodeling of the irradiated CNS is underscored by our data showing that the radiation-induced depletion of these cells is linked to the inhibition of neurogenesis and the onset of cognitive impairment. We believe oxidative injury is critical in this context, and plays a contributory if not causal role in determining neural precursor cell function, survival and fate. We have shown that oxidative stress significantly alters proliferation, radiosensitivity, mitochondrial function, and differentiation, and the studies proposed in this grant will extend these studies to space relevant irradiation paradigms. Significant new findings and accomplishments under the past reporting period are as follows: 1) We have optimized the growth conditions of our human neural stem cell system and have characterized these cells to low LET radiation modalities. We are now poised to subject these cells to charged particle irradiation. 2) We have generated new cell lines from mice deficient for the extracellular isoform of superoxide dismutase (EC-SOD). Studies have now been initiated to characterize how cells lacking this key antioxidant enzyme respond to ionizing radiation. 3) We have optimized the assessment of metabolic activity after low dose exposure using non-invasive 2-photon spectroscopy. 4) We have determined that dose rate along with total dose is an important parameter dictating the response of neural stem and precursor cells to proton irradiation. 5) We have expanded our prior studies showing that studies determining particle traversals at < or = 1 per cell elicit significant increases in oxidative stress. 6) We have also expanded our previous findings showing that low dose radiation-induced oxidative stress persists for many weeks to months following acute exposures. 7) We have significantly expanded our radioadaptive studies showing that prior exposure attenuates the increase in radiation-induced oxidative stress, leading to improved survival, enhanced DSB repair, and increased antioxidant capacity. 8) We have now completed, in collaboration with Dr. Ting-Ting Huang, the generation of mice harboring a tissue-specific (neural) version of the extracellular isoform of superoxide dismutase (EC-SOD) that can be switched off and on. We will begin to generate new inducible neural stem and precursor cells from these animals to more accurately assess the temporal dependence of radiation-induced oxidative stress on initial exposure. These cells will also be useful for controlling the timed expression of this antioxidant to determine if/how that impacts radioadaptive effects
Bibliography Type:	Description: (Last Updated: 01/14/2026)
Articles in Peer-reviewed Journals	Acharya MM, Lan ML, Kan VH, Patel NH, Giedzinski E, Tseng BP, Limoli CL. "Consequences of ionizing radiation-induced damage in human neural stem cells." Free Radical Biology and Medicine, 2010 Sep 6. [Epub ahead of print] PMID: 20826207 , Sep-2010